

But first, how can we know whether or not the Creator did in fact address a written revelation to us; and if He did, how can we identify it? Taking the point of view that the Sovereign Creator decided to furnish orientation to our race, He would know that He would have to make it recognizable for what it was, and the evidences would need to remain available to succeeding generations. But how can we know what means He would use to make His revelation recognizable? We can know by looking at what He has done, and working back, as it were. At this point, I must jump ahead to what I have concluded, based on the evidence, and then work back to see if my conclusion holds. I here state the pre-suppositions that I bring to my task: the Sovereign Creator exists, He has addressed a written Revelation to our race, and He has preserved it intact to this day to the extent that we can know what it is, based on objective criteria.

Introduction

Inspiration

When I write a book,¹ I identify myself as the author, and usually give some indication as to my purpose in writing it. As a Christian, I was taught that our Bible (containing 66 ‘books’) is a written Revelation given by the Sovereign Creator. So I ask: does the Bible identify itself, does it claim to be divinely inspired? I begin with the claim, and then attempt to verify it.

The claim

Genesis 1:1, “In the beginning God created the heavens and the earth”. The only One who could pass this information on to Adam (as I assume) was the Creator Himself; the Author is identifying Himself. Adam certainly developed a written form for the language God gave him, and he would have made a written record of all that the Creator told him about the beginning of this planet. Hundreds, if not thousands, of times throughout the Bible we encounter “God said”, or “the Lord said”. The prophetic books expressly claim to be messages given by God. Here is just one example: “The word of the LORD that came to Micah of Moresheth in the days of Jotham, Ahaz and Hezekiah, kings of Judah” (Micah 1:1).

Psalms 138:2, “You have magnified Your word above all Your name”. Since a person’s name represents that person, the point of that statement would appear to be that God’s word represents His person even better than does His name. “Forever, O LORD, Your word is settled in heaven” (Psalms

¹ I have published eight, so far, plus a Greek Text.